

Indianization of the railroad workforce in full realization of a long-standing nationalist demand". The number of people employed by the Indian Railways remained high even after Independence. While senior staff members were recruited by Railway Service Commissions, high-ranking officials were appointed through the government-run public service commissions. The labour workforce was hired by local committees. Although some of the labour force remained casual, the Indian Railways, as a Government-owned employer, provided many amenities to its employees. These included housing units, schools, and medical and travel facilities. As with most enterprises, there were some troubles with the labour unions, but overall the condition remained satisfactory.

PRESIDENTIAL SALOON

In 1956, a twin-carriage red saloon was built for the President of India for his or her rail journeys. It constituted a dining room, a lounge, a bedroom, a kitchen, and chambers for the President's staff. With teak furniture and silk upholstery, it was designed to incorporate luxury and comfort. In 2003, the saloon was modified to accommodate modern facilities, such as Wi-Fi. After being in service for more than five decades, the saloon was finally decommissioned in 2008 owing to safety concerns.

Passenger services

While railway travel had always been popular during India's colonial period, the number of passengers increased by 1,147 million between 1950–51 and 1970–71 and showed an upward trend throughout the last quarter of the 20th century. Independence also paved the way for a national railways committed towards providing good and affordable service to every Indian, unlike earlier, when its objective was making a profit.

Fares, which were inconsistent across different railways and did not always correspond to the amenities provided, improved as well. From 1948, the railways adopted a uniform fare structure. Any increase during the revisions was in direct proportion to the provision of additional facilities.